Hayat Dahraj
March 8, 2026

OPENING STATEMENT

This report presents findings from a Qualtrics eSurvey examining how the Denton-area community perceives school communication practices, conducted in support of the Project Clara proposal. Project Clara is a proposed mobile application built with React Native and AWS that would consolidate school communication into a single platform for Denton K-12 public schools. **After analyzing 33 valid eSurvey responses, three thematic findings emerged: current school communication is fragmented across too many tools and leaves families feeling uninformed, respondents strongly favor a unified app with features like emergency alerts and teacher messaging, and data security for student information remains a top concern among community members.**

BACKGROUND AND METHODOLOGY

The Qualtrics eSurvey embraced a primary research approach to gather empirical data about school communication experiences and preferences. The anonymous survey was distributed via social media platforms, text messages, and direct outreach to UNT classmates and Denton-area contacts between February 28 and March 5, 2026, collecting 33 complete responses out of 34 total. Respondents included UNT students with K-12 siblings, community members, parents, teachers, and others. Though 33 respondents represent only a fraction of the broader Denton community and the sample skews toward college-aged respondents rather than parents who navigate school communication daily, many reported firsthand knowledge of these challenges through their families, and total eSurvey data showcased a clear pattern of findings regarding the need for improved school communication.

FINDINGS

Fragmented Communication Leaves Families Uninformed

ESurvey data revealed a pattern of dissatisfaction rooted in the fragmented nature of school communication. When asked about their satisfaction with current methods, only 10 of 33 respondents expressed any level of satisfaction, while 16 were neutral and 7 were dissatisfied. See Figure 1 below. This pattern becomes clearer when cross-referenced with the tools schools currently use. Respondents reported that schools rely on an average of three to four different platforms simultaneously: email was cited by 29 respondents, phone calls or robocalls by 23, social media by 20, and text messages by 13. Only 10 noted a dedicated school-specific app such as ClassDojo or Remind. Of the 33 respondents, 14 confirmed they currently juggle more than one app or tool for school updates. Open-ended responses reinforced this theme. One respondent explained that their family "sometimes struggle[s] with the multiple communication modes" because information appears on a district Facebook page first and is distributed later by email or phone. Another noted "confusion from different system operation platform[s]" and called for the "same info" to appear on all systems. These findings suggest that fragmentation across platforms is a core problem that a unified solution like Project Clara could address.

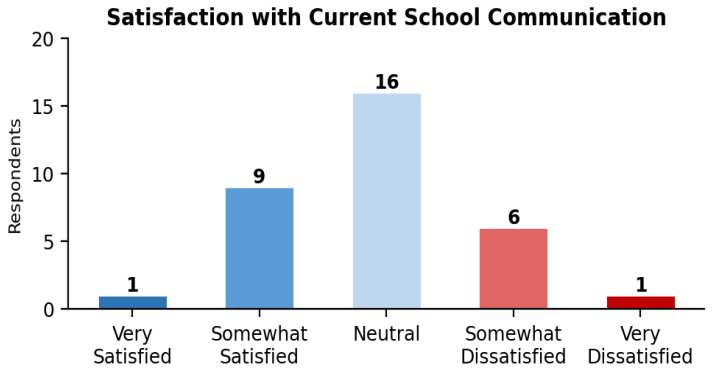

Figure 1: Respondent satisfaction with current school communication methods (n=33).

Strong Demand for a Unified, Feature-Rich Platform

Respondents expressed clear interest in consolidating school communication into a single platform. When asked how likely they would be to use such an app, 12 selected "Very Likely" and 8 selected "Somewhat Likely," meaning over 60% indicated willingness to adopt. Eleven were neutral and only 2 were somewhat unlikely, with no respondent selecting "Very Unlikely." See Figure 2 below. This openness to adoption aligns with the frustration documented in the previous finding and suggests respondents are actively seeking a better solution.

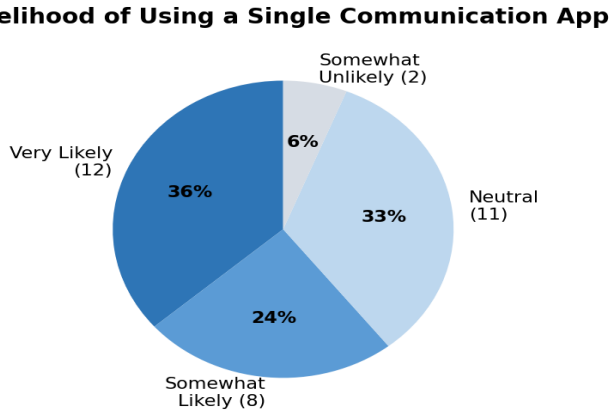

Figure 2: Likelihood of adopting a single school communication app (n=33).

The eSurvey also assessed which specific features respondents value most. Emergency notifications, absence reporting, and student records access all received majority support in the "Very Important" or "Extremely Important" categories, while teacher messaging and homework reminders also drew strong interest. See Figure 3 below. These priorities map directly onto Project Clara's proposed feature set, which includes real-time incident alerts, two-way parent-teacher messaging, absence reporting, and centralized student records. Open-ended comments echoed these preferences. One respondent wrote that a single app allowing parents to "see their children's assignment, grades, and progress" while communicating with teachers "would be very helpful." Another stated that "one streamlined app that houses everything would likely eliminate communication issues."

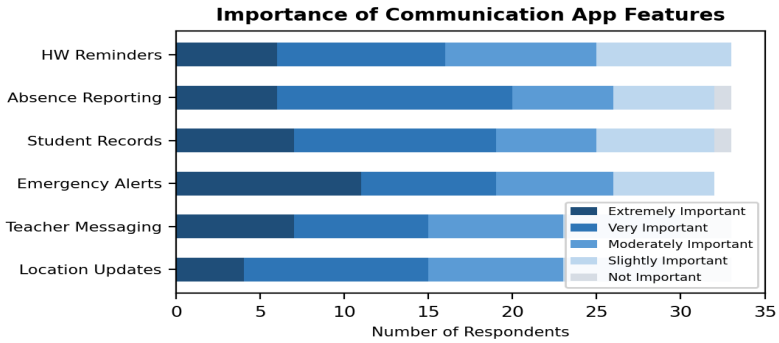

Figure 3: Importance ratings for proposed communication app features (n=33).

Security of Student Data Is a Critical Concern

The eSurvey also captured significant concern about data security. Of the 32 respondents who answered this question, 11 selected "Very Concerned" and 9 selected "Somewhat Concerned," meaning nearly two-thirds expressed some level of worry about their child's personal information being stored in school apps. The remaining 12 were neutral, and notably, no respondent indicated they were unconcerned. See Figure 4 below. One respondent emphasized that "safety is important in schools," reinforcing that trust in a platform's security practices will be essential for adoption. These findings underscore why Project Clara's architecture prioritizes AWS-based encryption, role-based access control, and secure storage for sensitive records including medications, emergency contacts, and behavioral documentation.

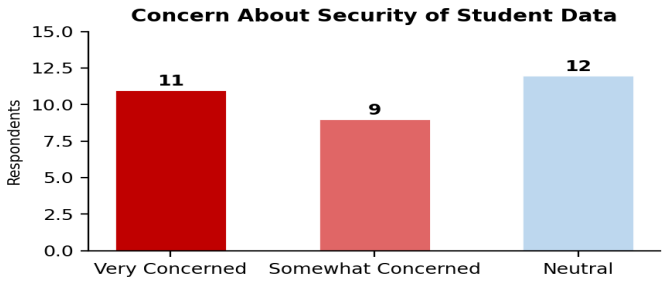

Figure 4: Concern about security of student data in school apps (n=32).

CONCLUSION

This eSurvey report examined how respondents in the Denton area perceive current school communication and their openness to a unified platform. The data revealed three main themes: dissatisfaction driven by fragmented tools that scatter information across too many platforms, strong willingness to adopt a single consolidated app with features like emergency alerts and teacher messaging, and meaningful concern about the security of student data. These findings support both the feasibility and the community need for Project Clara, and this eSurvey data strengthens the Unit 3 Proposal by demonstrating that a real demand exists for the improvement Project Clara aims to provide.

WORKS CITED

Dahraj, Hayat. "Project Clara Communication Survey." *Qualtrics*, University of North Texas, 8 Mar. 2026.